



Dear Diary,
I think six days of waking up early and racing to catch the school bus has coiled my whole system as good as the clock. Here I was on a lazy Saturday, up and alert at 8 am. I did not know what to do. Mum and dad had left for work, my sister Shubhie was fast asleep. I cosied up to my laptop and went on to the Internet to see if my e-mail had been fixed. I had forgotten my password and they are like taking ages to recover it. Oh my God, my friends are going to disown me for not having an account on Facebook. I will have to just tell them that my Internet is not working and that I have an account with strict privacy settings. So they cannot see me unless I change the settings. I clicked on Google images and searched for Johnny Depp. He is so cute. I love him and all his movies. He is really funny. I think I should have my own Depp scrapbook, like my friend Deryani has of Edward Cullen. When, I had to almost knock the computer out of Shubhie's sight. Why does she always enter like a secret agent? Must have come from watching all those CID episodes and the silly ACP Pradyuman and detectives Daya and what's his name? Thank God she did not see what I was up to. She likes Depp too but why would I want to tell her? We both yelled for our dog and spent some time playing with her. Taara, our golden lab, is forever hungry. Srishti, my best friend, called, she wanted me to go to her place for a sleepover. But mum did not let me. She says I am growing up and hitting puberty, I should not go for night outs. None of it makes sense to me. I was so angry that I fought with my sister. "You have buck teeth," I said, to which she replied, "I will tell mum that you bunk class and sit near the clinic to chit-chat with your friends. I will also tell her about how you pull up your skirt and roll down your socks right before entering school." She is so mean. I will not go to the mall with her. I will go alone and buy three new Sweet Valleys. xoxo
Saanchie



THE BIG SISTER: SAANCHIE GOSWAMY, 11, DELHI

'dude' you are. Even girls don't go for the chocolate boys anymore. Wanting to be the bad boy for the naughty girls is what sucks them deeper into the 'macho' attitude.

Appearances are important for both. As a Cartoon Network New Generations survey of 3,431 children between seven and 14 across 15 cities points out, being a consumer is important to them, whether it is 90 per cent in the 11-14-year-old group watching TV ads to know about new products or 84 per cent declaring they want

clothes which are fashionable. They have multiple sources of what-is-cool and are skilled at using the Internet. "We have had parents of Class III students talking about how their children are surfing pornographic sites or how they found their daughters photos on Facebook sexually provocative," says Delhi-based psychologist Shelja Sen. A school principal in Jaipur speaks of how a girl carried a picture of her breasts on her cellphone to show how she was growing faster than her peers.

Doctors and teachers, who often counsel children not to fidget with

their private parts, chronicle several cases of pre-teens trying to kiss and even indulge in oral sex. Teachers of most co-educational schools make regular rounds of isolated spots like washrooms, water coolers and playgrounds to prevent students from exhibiting any uncalled for behaviour.

EXPOSURE UNLIMITED

Everything is within easy reach

Psychologist Anjali Chhabria from Mumbai speaks of an 11-year-old boy who wanted to kill himself after developing a sexual obsession. His friends introduced him to pornographic content on the Internet but he was unable to handle it. Another 14-year-old sent nude pictures of herself to a boy who had asked her to do so. Too much of exposure too early is resulting in